

WUBI is the acronym for 'Windows based Ubuntu installer'. It is a very small utility that helps you install Ubuntu on a system running Windows. The important thing to note here is WUBI does not require a separate partition, whereas it creates a special file on the Windows partition and uses that file as the Ubuntu drive. The user can very well uninstall Ubuntu from the Windows control panel.

To install Ubuntu using WUBI, one needs to follow a few basic steps:

1. Download the WUBI utility from <http://www.ubuntu.com/download/desktop/windows-installer> and then install it on a Windows desktop machine.
2. Start the WUBI utility and in the *Installation directory*, select the Ubuntu flavour to install it from the drop down menu.
3. Click on *Install* to start the installation.
4. The normal Ubuntu installation will proceed and in the end, you will see the wizard asking you to reboot.
5. After reboot, the next boot user will see the Windows boot manager displaying two operating systems to boot from.
6. Choose Ubuntu, boot into it and start exploring it.

Try Linux with a live CD

Till now, we have looked at how to experience emulated versions of Linux on Windows. Let's move a step ahead and try out real Linux. Now, we certainly have to leave our Windows environment. But here, the objective is to experience Linux without affecting the already installed Windows in any way.

Let's see how we run Linux with a live CD/DVD.

1. First, download the desired Linux flavour LiveCD image from any of the hundreds of available repositories, some of which are listed below:
 - a. <https://livecdlist.com/>
 - b. <http://www.knopper.net/knoppix/index-en.html>
 - c. <http://www.linux.com/directory/Distributions/livecd>
2. Now go to your systems BIOS setting and alter the boot options to enable you to boot from the CD/DVD.
3. We are now ready to boot into Linux. Just put the CD/DVD in your disk drive and reboot your desktop.
4. When the boot is complete, you will see that you have booted into Linux.
5. The only disadvantage of using a live CD is that nothing is persistent and everything starts from scratch with the next boot.

Try Linux using a pen drive

We have booted Linux with a CD/DVD image but what if our system doesn't have a disk drive? The solution is to boot into the Linux operating system from a USB stick. Any normal USB stick can be used to install

a live Linux image, which gives us a mobile operating system ready to use anywhere, right in our pocket. To install Linux on a pen drive, you need one with a minimum capacity of 2GB, a Linux installer ISO image, and a computer to boot from.

There are broadly two ways of installing Linux on USB flash drives.

1. **Installing Linux on a USB flash drive manually:** Here, we start a normal Linux installation and at the stage where we have to select the disk drive on which to install, the user carefully selects the USB flash disk drive. The only concern with this approach is that the user must have a very basic understanding of how disk drives are represented in Linux, and should be able to differentiate between USB flash storage and other disk drives present in the system.
2. **Use the USB Linux installer utility:** The concern mentioned in relation to the first approach is not so serious. Various Linux distros provide a solution to it. There are hundreds of free utilities available on the Internet, which install Linux on a USB flash drive from Windows. A few such utilities are listed here.
 - a. **LinuxLive USB Creator:** This is a free, open source Windows application that allows you to install Linux on a flash drive. You can download and install the application first; and then, in just four to five steps, have your USB flash drive ready to boot Linux:
 - i. Start the application from the Windows *Start* menu and choose the disk from the *drives* list.
 - ii. Select the ISO file or a CD as the installation source.
 - iii. Choose the size of persistent data, so that the contents on this disk space on the flash drive will persist on it even after reboot.
 - iv. Now, click on the 'lightning' button to start the image creation/installation.
 - v. This utility can be downloaded from <http://www.linuxliveusb.com/>.
 - b. **Universal USB Installer:** Universal USB Installer or UUI is another live Linux USB creator that allows you to install Linux on a flash drive from Windows. Here again, you just need to download and install the utility and follow a couple of very basic self-explanatory steps to have a Linux bootable USB flash drive ready. UUI can be downloaded from <http://www.pendrivelinux.com/universal-usb-installer-easy-as-1-2-3/>.
 - c. **UNetbootin:** This is another application that allows you to create a bootable Linux image on a flash drive using Windows. UNetbootin can be downloaded from <http://unetbootin.github.io/>.

The list of such utilities is never ending and they are increasing, day by day. One advantage of running Linux using a USB flash drive rather than a live CD is that you get